Bhutanese capital. Quick to take offence at what was described as the 'high-handed behaviour' of the Bhutanese, the second mission led to a stronger British force moving into the Himalayan kingdom. The first clash took place at Daling, east of Darjeeling and then again at Dewangiri, north of Rangiya. In 1866, the Bhutanese agreed to comply with the British terms regarding the delineation of the border.

The eastern boundary of Bhutan bordered the Monpa and Sherdukpen region of NEFA. At that time the only approach to Tawang was through Bhutan and hence it was not on the immediate radar of the British government. To the immediate north of Darrang district, the Aka tribe dominated the Kameng River Valley that was further flanked to the east by the Dafla and the Miri tribes. The Abor (now known as Adi) inhabited the hills between Subansiri and the Dibang river valleys while the three Mishmi groups had made the region bordering Burma their home. Though none of these tribes were as hostile to the British as the Naga, Kuki and Lushai that inhabited the Naga-Patkai range of mountains, the British continued to be wary of the NEFA region, their military probes being fairly shallow.

All military expeditions by the British, though labelled as punitive measures to punish the tribes for transgressing outside their area, were in effect part of their attempt to bring the frontier under their control. Though there had been minor incidents involving the Daflas and the Miris in the past, the real trouble started in 1848 when Abor warriors abducted several plains dwellers. The raid had been primarily carried out by the tribe to assert their share in the gold and fish taken from the rivers flowing through their land. Initial measures taken against the Abor (including a punitive raid under Captain Vetch) only resulted in more retaliatory acts, until the British mounted a major military campaign in 1868-69. The first attempt was a miserable failure, but the second time around a stronger force succeeded in making headway against the Abors's carefully prepared defences despite suffering heavy casualties. Finally, only after the last stockade was taken at the point of the bayonet, did the Abor submit.

At that point of time, the Abors controlled the Siang River Valley; of all the NEFA tribes, they were the most hostile towards any transgression in their area. In 1864, it was decided that a fairly large force known as the Lakhimpur Armed Police Battalion (later 2 Assam Rifles) would have to be based at Dibrugarh to look after both the Sadiya and the Lakhimpur districts. In the 1870s, the Lakhimpur Battalion was deployed against both